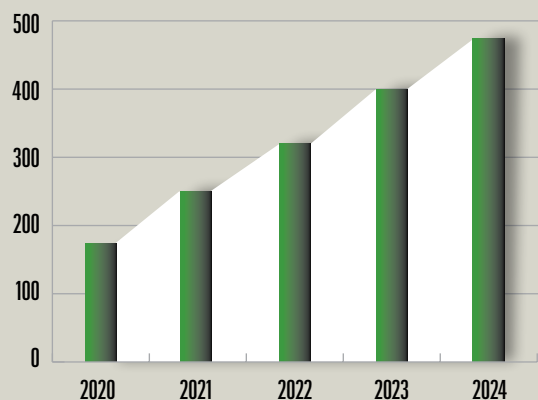


INDIAN ANTI-OBESITY DRUG MARKET SIZE (₹CR)



SOURCE IMS HEALTH INDIA: MARKET ANALYSIS

ity, access and awareness,” he says.

According to Grand View Research, India’s obesity treatment market is growing at a rapid clip. It generated around ₹760 crore (\$91.6 million) revenue in 2024, projected to touch nearly ₹2,710 crore (\$326.6 million) by 2030, a compound annual growth rate of 25%.

The adoption of semaglutide-based drugs is already reshaping the market. Sales of Novo Nordisk’s Rybelsus, an oral form of semaglutide, grew 60% in 2022 and 66% in 2023, says Makreo Research.

Indian pharmaceutical majors such as Sun Pharma, Cipla, Dr. Reddy’s and Lupin are also developing their own versions of weight-loss drugs like Wegovy. Biocon

is also ready to jump on the bandwagon. The global GLP (glucagon-like peptide) market is projected to reach \$130–135 billion by FY29. As key peptide drugs like Semaglutide and Tirzepatide begin to lose patent protection, significant opportunities will open up for biopharma companies like Biocon. Near-term, Biocon is targeting Liraglutide (\$2 billion annual sales) and Semaglutide in emerging markets (\$4–5 billion sales). It has launched its Liraglutide in the UK, has secured approvals from the EMA for Europe and filed with the USFDA. Its diabetes pipeline includes Liraglutide, Semaglutide and Tirzepatide. “We have built a robust GLP-1 portfolio to address the growing challenge of diabetes. Biocon is advancing its diabetes pipeline, including Semaglutide and Tirzepatide, towards major global markets such as Europe, the US, and key emerging economies,” says Siddharth Mittal, CEO & MD, Biocon.

The global obesity drug market is expected to soar to over ₹8.3 lakh crore (\$100 billion) annually by the end of the decade. The potential is too large to be ignored. But so are the risks.

HEALTHY COMPETITION

The entry of Lilly’s Mounjaro has stirred the pricing debate, especially as Novo’s Wegovy is likely to be sold at a premium. “While we are working to make Wegovy available in India this year, we are also mindful of ensuring that people get it at a competitive price,” says Shrotriya. He points to the broader role of semaglutide. “Obesity management goes beyond weight reduction. It plays a critical role in mitigating risk associated with serious co-morbidities. GLP-1 receptor agonists such as semaglutide have shown efficacy not only in obesity management but also in addressing related conditions, including type 2 diabetes and cardiovascular disorders,” he says. An agonist is a molecule (like a drug or a hormone) that binds to a receptor on a cell and triggers a biological response. Novo knows that competition in India will only grow, especially after 2026, when semaglutide goes off-patent and local generic players begin to enter the segment en masse. Shrotriya sees this as a natural progression. “Patent expiry is a natural phase in the lifecycle of pharmaceutical products,” he says. “Despite more options, there is a significant unmet need for effective therapies for type 2 diabetes and obesity. There is a need to expand access to existing treatments and develop innovative solutions. Ultimately, innovation remains the key differentiator,” he adds.

Novo’s upcoming launch of Wegovy in India marks a significant step in weight management and diabetes care, says Dr Anoop Misra, Chairman, Fortis C-DOC